Nishikant Mishra

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SUMMARY

Azure DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer with 6+ years of IT experience, including 3.5+ years of hands-on experience designing, implementing, and managing secure, scalable, and production-grade cloud infrastructure on Microsoft Azure. Strong expertise in Azure DevOps, Azure Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Azure Bicep, ARM Templates, Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), Helm, GitOps, Infrastructure as Code, and cloud automation.

Experienced in designing reusable YAML pipelines, automating infrastructure provisioning and application deployments, implementing DevSecOps practices, and establishing secure CI/CD workflows using SonarQube, Snyk, Tfsec, TFLint, PSRule for Azure, and TruffleHog. Hands-on exposure to Azure App Services, Azure API Management, Azure SQL Database, Azure Storage, Azure Key Vault, Microsoft Entra ID, Managed Identity, Service Principals, RBAC, and Azure Policy.

Exposure to Azure AI services and modern AI application architectures, including Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, Azure AI Search, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), AI-powered applications, and Agentic AI concepts. Experienced in supporting cloud infrastructure and CI/CD automation for AI-enabled and microservices-based workloads.

Experienced in Kubernetes-based deployment automation, GitOps practices, release governance, branch protection, automated validation, security gates, rollback strategies, monitoring, and production troubleshooting. Strong exposure to Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenCost for monitoring, observability, and cloud cost visibility. Strong problem-solving and incident troubleshooting skills with experience collaborating with development, platform engineering, security, infrastructure, and application teams in Agile/DevOps environments.

EXPERIENCE

Azure DevOps Engineer March 2023 – Present

Appgo Solutions Pvt. Ltd. *Hyderabad*

- Designed, implemented, and maintained enterprise CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps YAML Pipelines and GitHub Actions for reliable and scalable application delivery.
- Developed reusable YAML pipeline templates and GitHub Composite Actions to standardize CI/CD workflows across multiple projects and improve deployment consistency.
- Managed source code repositories using Azure Repos and GitHub Enterprise while implementing Git branching strategies, branch protection, and pull request governance.
- Participated in Azure DevOps to GitHub migration covering repositories, CI/CD pipelines, branch policies, and workflow migration.
- Provisioned and managed Azure cloud infrastructure using Terraform and Azure Bicep following Infrastructure as Code best practices.
- Developed and maintained reusable Terraform modules and automated infrastructure provisioning across Azure environments.
- Managed Azure App Services, Azure API Management, Azure SQL Database, Storage Accounts, Azure Key Vault, and containerized workloads deployed on Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS).
- Implemented Docker-based containerization and Kubernetes deployment automation for application and microservices workloads.
- Used Helm and GitOps-based deployment strategies to manage Kubernetes application releases and improve deployment consistency.

- Implemented DevSecOps practices by integrating SonarQube, Snyk, Tfsec, TFLint, PSRule for Azure, and TruffleHog into CI/CD pipelines.
- Implemented automated security and compliance gates for source code, dependencies, infrastructure configurations, and secrets.
- Configured Microsoft Entra ID, App Registrations, Managed Identity, Service Principals, Azure RBAC, and Azure Key Vault for secure authentication, authorization, and secret management.
- Implemented secure CI/CD practices through branch protection policies, pull request validations, release approvals, security gates, and deployment governance.
- Configured Azure API Management to securely expose and manage backend APIs and microservices.
- Implemented GitOps-based deployment strategies for Kubernetes workloads and automated application releases.
- Implemented monitoring and observability using Azure Monitor and Log Analytics for Azure infrastructure and application health.
- Worked with Prometheus and Grafana for Kubernetes and application monitoring, metrics visualization, and alerting.
- Used OpenCost to provide Kubernetes/cloud cost visibility and identify opportunities for workload and infrastructure cost optimization.
- Troubleshot Azure infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes deployments, authentication issues, application deployments, and production incidents.
- Performed root cause analysis and implemented corrective actions to improve application and infrastructure reliability.
- Improved deployment reliability through automated validation, security gates, controlled releases, and rollback strategies.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning and application deployment using reusable Terraform modules and standardized YAML pipeline templates.
- Collaborated with development, platform engineering, security, and operations teams to define DevOps standards, CI/CD best practices, automation strategies, and release governance.

Tech Support Engineer (Cloud) December 2021 – January 2023

iEnergizer *Noida*

- Provided L1/L2 technical support for client applications, systems, and cloud-based environments while meeting defined SLA requirements.
- Diagnosed and resolved software, network, system, and application-related issues across production environments.
- Monitored application performance, system availability, and operational alerts to ensure uninterrupted business operations.
- Investigated production incidents, performed root cause analysis, and coordinated with development, infrastructure, and support teams for issue resolution.
- Assisted with Azure cloud resource monitoring and basic cloud administration activities.
- Supported application deployment and release activities by validating application functionality and troubleshooting post-deployment issues.
- Monitored system and application health and escalated critical production incidents to appropriate engineering teams.
- Managed user accounts, permissions, and access requests in accordance with organizational security policies.
- Assisted with troubleshooting cloud-based application and infrastructure issues within defined SLA timelines.
- Created and maintained technical documentation, knowledge-base articles, troubleshooting guides, and operational procedures.
- Worked closely with development, infrastructure, and support teams to improve service reliability and customer satisfaction.
- Tracked incidents through resolution and ensured timely communication with relevant stakeholders.

Technical Support Associate September 2020 – July 2021

Optum Global Solutions *Gurugram*

- Provided technical support to end users by troubleshooting application, system, access, and environment-related issues.

- Managed incidents and service requests through enterprise ticketing systems while meeting defined SLA requirements.
- Performed troubleshooting of Windows environments, network connectivity, enterprise applications, and system-related issues.
- Assisted users with account provisioning, password resets, access management, and permission-related requests.
- Monitored system alerts and escalated critical issues to senior support and engineering teams.
- Supported software installation, configuration, maintenance, and operational activities.
- Conducted application health checks and assisted with routine operational support activities.
- Documented troubleshooting procedures and maintained knowledge-base articles for recurring issues.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to ensure timely resolution of technical problems and service requests.

System Analyst Intern November 2019 – February 2020

nThrive Global Solutions *Noida*

- Assisted in monitoring application and system performance and identifying operational issues.
- Supported incident troubleshooting and issue resolution activities under the guidance of senior team members.
- Performed basic system maintenance and operational support tasks.
- Assisted in preparing technical documentation, operational reports, and troubleshooting guides.
- Worked with senior team members to analyze and resolve reported application and system issues.
- Participated in application testing, validation, and deployment support activities.
- Assisted with routine application health checks and operational monitoring.

PROJECTS

Enterprise AI-Powered EdTech Cloud Platform – Azure DevOps, DevSecOps & Agentic AI | Environment: Microsoft Azure, Azure DevOps, Terraform, Azure Bicep, Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), Helm, GitHub, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, Azure AI Search, Azure AI Document Intelligence, Azure Key Vault, Microsoft Entra ID, Prometheus, Grafana, SonarQube, Snyk, Tfsec, TFLint, PowerShell, Bash

- Designed an AI-enabled, scalable Azure-based EdTech platform supporting containerized microservices for student management, course management, assessments, authentication, content management, and AI-powered learning capabilities.
- Provisioned Azure cloud infrastructure using reusable Terraform modules and Azure Bicep, following Infrastructure as Code (IaC), scalability, security, and governance best practices.
- Designed Azure DevOps YAML CI/CD pipelines to automate source-code validation, Docker image builds, security scanning, infrastructure validation, and application deployments.
- Containerized application and AI service components using Docker and deployed workloads to Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) using Kubernetes and Helm.
- Integrated Azure OpenAI Service to support AI-powered educational use cases such as intelligent question answering, learning assistance, content summarization, and personalized learning interactions.
- Designed an AI-powered Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) architecture using Azure OpenAI and Azure AI Search to enable contextual responses based on course materials and educational content.
- Implemented Azure AI Search for indexing and retrieving educational documents, course content, FAQs, and knowledge-base information used by AI-powered applications.
- Used Azure AI Foundry concepts and services for developing, evaluating, and integrating AI-powered applications and agent-based workflows.
- Designed Agentic AI workflows where AI agents can interpret user requests, retrieve relevant educational information, invoke application capabilities, and generate contextual responses.
- Implemented tool/function-calling concepts to allow AI agents to interact with application APIs and backend services for education-related workflows.
- Integrated Azure AI Document Intelligence for extracting and processing structured information from educational documents and uploaded content.
- Implemented secure access to AI and Azure resources using Microsoft Entra ID, Managed Identity, Azure RBAC, and Azure Key Vault.
- Integrated SonarQube and Snyk into CI/CD pipelines for static code analysis, dependency vulnerability scanning, and code-quality enforcement.

- Integrated Tfsec and TFLint into infrastructure pipelines to identify Terraform security issues, configuration problems, and IaC quality issues before deployment.
- Implemented GitOps-based deployment practices for Kubernetes and AI-enabled workloads to improve deployment consistency and release management.
- Implemented monitoring and observability using Prometheus and Grafana for Kubernetes workloads, application metrics, AI service workloads, resource utilization, and alerting.
- Used Azure Monitor and Log Analytics for centralized monitoring of Azure infrastructure, applications, APIs, and AI-enabled workloads.
- Implemented deployment validation, approval gates, branch protection, security gates, and rollback strategies to improve application and AI workload release reliability.
- Automated infrastructure and application deployment workflows using Terraform, Azure DevOps YAML, PowerShell, and Bash scripting.
- Applied DevSecOps practices across AI application development and deployment by incorporating source-code scanning, dependency scanning, infrastructure security validation, secret detection, and deployment controls.
- Troubleshot Kubernetes deployments, CI/CD failures, Azure infrastructure issues, API connectivity, authentication, AI service integration, and application deployment problems.
- Optimized containerized and AI-enabled workloads based on resource utilization, monitoring metrics, application performance, and cloud cost visibility.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Microsoft Azure
AWS
Azure App Services
Azure API Management (APIM)
Azure SQL Database
Azure Storage Accounts
Azure Key Vault
Azure Monitor
Log Analytics
Microsoft Entra ID
Managed Identity
Service Principals
Azure RBAC
Azure Policy
Azure DevOps
Azure Repos
Azure Pipelines
GitHub Enterprise
GitHub Actions
YAML Pipelines
Reusable Pipeline Templates
GitHub Composite Actions
Release Management
Deployment Automation
Release Governance
Terraform
Terraform Modules
Azure Bicep
ARM Templates
Infrastructure as Code (IaC)

Docker
Kubernetes
Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)
Helm
GitOps
Containerized Workloads
Kubernetes Deployment Automation
SonarQube
Snyk
Tfsec
TFLint
PSRule for Azure
TruffleHog
Security Gates
Secure CI/CD
Prometheus
Grafana
OpenCost
Application Monitoring
Metrics
Logging
Alerting
Git
GitHub
Git Branching Strategies
Branch Protection Policies
Pull Request Validation
PowerShell
Bash
Python
YAML
Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, RHEL)
Windows Server
Azure OpenAI Service
Azure AI Foundry
Azure AI Search
Generative AI
Large Language Models (LLMs)
Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
Agentic AI
AI Agents
Prompt Engineering
Tool/Function Calling
AI Application Integration
Vector Search
DevOps
DevSecOps
Agile

CI/CD
Automation
Microservices
Production Support
Incident Management
Root Cause Analysis

KEY AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Azure Cloud Infrastructure & Administration Azure DevOps & CI/CD Automation Infrastructure as Code using Terraform & Bicep Kubernetes / AKS & Docker Helm & GitOps DevSecOps & CI/CD Security Azure OpenAI & Generative AI Azure AI Foundry Agentic AI & AI Agents RAG & Azure AI Search AI Application Deployment & Automation Cloud Security & Identity Management Azure RBAC & Microsoft Entra ID Monitoring & Observability Prometheus & Grafana Production Troubleshooting & Incident Management Release Governance & Deployment Automation Microservices & Containerized Applications Infrastructure Automation Cloud Cost Optimization Agile / DevOps Collaboration